

THREAT INTELLIGENCE INVESTIGATION REPORT

TI-2026-001

SUSPECTED BRAND IMPERSONATION CAMPAIGN TARGETING JOB SEEKERS USING HIGHLIGHT



CASE ID
TI-2026-001



DATE
28 June 2026



CLASSIFICATION
TLP: CLEAR



ANALYST
Mounir KOUSKOUS



INVESTIGATION TYPE
OSINT / Threat Intelligence



STATUS
FINAL

OBJECTIVE

Analyser et évaluer une campagne suspecte se présentant comme une opportunité de recrutement liée à la plateforme NFT/Web3 Highlight, et déterminer si le domaine [highlight-global.xyz](#) est légitime et autorisé par l'entité officielle exploitant [highlight.xyz](#).

SCOPE

- Domaines : [highlight.xyz](#), [highlight-global.xyz](#), [apihighlight.xyz](#), [dot01mf.cfd](#)
- Communications : RCS, WhatsApp, LinkedIn
- Analyse technique : DNS, WHOIS, TLS, HTTP, Code source, Infrastructure
- Analyse comportementale et contextuelle
- Collecte d'indicateurs et corrélation
- Évaluation des risques et recommandations

RÉSUMÉ RAPIDE



RISQUE
CRITICAL



CONFIANCE
HIGH



IMPACT
HIGH



CIBLE
JOB SEEKERS



SECTEUR
WEB3 / NFT



DISCLAIMER

Ce rapport est basé uniquement sur des informations publiques (OSINT) et des observations techniques réalisées à la date indiquée. Il ne constitue pas une preuve juridique. Les conclusions sont basées sur un niveau de confiance et peuvent évoluer avec de nouvelles informations.

Executive Dashboard

Item	Value
Case ID	TI-2026-001
Confidence	HIGH
Risk	CRITICAL
Target	Job Seekers
Campaign	Suspected Web3 Recruitment
Classification	TLP:CLEAR

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Threat Intelligence Investigation Report

Case ID

TI-2026-001

Title

Suspected Web3 Recruitment Brand Impersonation Campaign Using Highlight

Classification

TLP:CLEAR

Analyst

Mounir KOUSKOUS

Date

28 June 2026

Investigation Type

OSINT / Threat Intelligence

Status

Final

Objective

Analyze and assess a suspicious recruitment campaign claiming association with the NFT/Web3 platform Highlight, and determine whether highlight-global.xyz is legitimate and authorized by the official entity operating highlight.xyz.

Scope

- Domains: highlight.xyz, highlight-global.xyz, apihighlight.xyz, dot01mf.cfd
- Communications: RCS, WhatsApp, LinkedIn reference
- Technical analysis: DNS, WHOIS/RDAP, TLS, HTTP, frontend code, infrastructure
- Behavioral and contextual analysis
- Indicator collection and correlation
- Risk assessment and recommendations

Disclaimer

This report is based only on publicly available information (OSINT), user-provided screenshots, and technical observations made during the investigation. It is not a legal determination. Conclusions are expressed using confidence levels and may evolve if new information becomes available.

Executive Dashboard

Element	Value
Confidence	HIGH
Likelihood	HIGH
Impact	HIGH

Element	Value
Risk	CRITICAL
Target	Job seekers
Sector	Web3 / NFT
Type	Brand impersonation / fake recruitment
Primary Domain	highlight-global.xyz
Referenced Brand	Highlight
ATT&CK	T1583.001 / T1585 / T1566 / T1036 / T1204

1. Executive Summary

This investigation covers a suspicious contact presenting itself as a recruitment opportunity linked to the Web3/NFT platform **Highlight**.

The interlocutor claimed to operate as part of the Highlight project and redirected the victim to **highlight-global.xyz**, described as a work platform or backend associated with **highlight.xyz**.

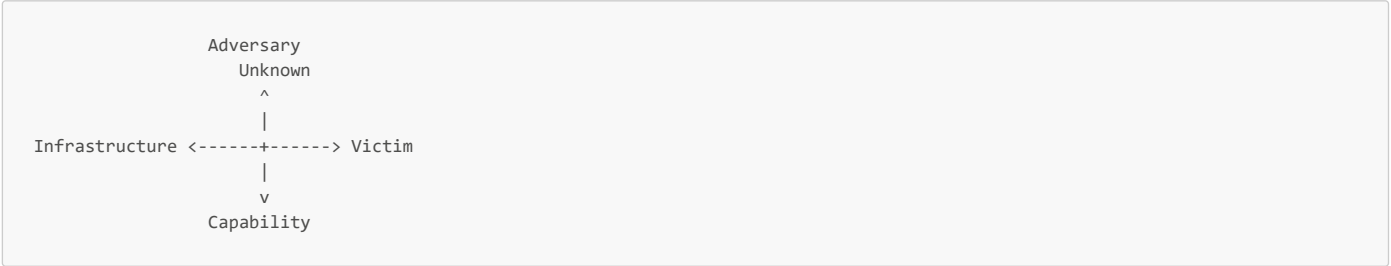
Based on the collected evidence, there is **high confidence** that **highlight-global.xyz** is not officially operated by, or authorized by, **Sea Ranch Labs, Inc. d/b/a Highlight**, the entity operating the legitimate **highlight.xyz** platform.

The observed campaign exhibits multiple indicators commonly associated with Web3/NFT fake job scams:

- Recently registered domain.
- Infrastructure unrelated to the official Highlight platform.
- No public authorization from **highlight.xyz**.
- No official **@highlight.xyz** email contact.
- Referral code mechanism.
- Daily remuneration promise.
- Wallet, commission, salary and withdrawal features.
- Separate withdrawal password mechanism.
- Inconsistent explanation about a supposed official frontend and separate backend.
- Use of personal communication channels instead of official company channels.

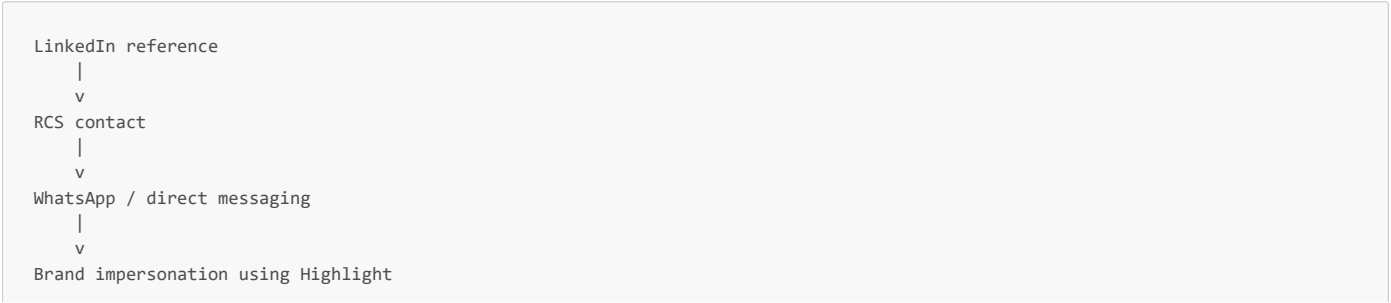
Assessment: High confidence that the observed activity represents a brand impersonation and fake recruitment campaign targeting job seekers, including LinkedIn users and cybersecurity candidates.

2. Diamond Model



Diamond Element	Observed Value
Adversary	Unknown actor or group
Infrastructure	highlight-global.xyz, apihighlight.xyz, dot01mf.cfd, cf.dot01mf.cfd, chat.imkefu.uk
Capability	Fake job workflow, referral code, registration, wallet, salary, commission, withdrawal password
Victim	LinkedIn users, cybersecurity candidates, job seekers, Web3/NFT-adjacent users

3. Campaign Kill Chain



```
|
v
Redirection to highlight-global.xyz
|
v
Registration with referral code
|
v
Fake task workflow: Improve NFTs / Submit
|
v
Wallet / Salary / Commission display
|
v
Withdraw password collection
|
v
Potential future deposit or fee request
```

This chain is based on observed messages, frontend code, and infrastructure. The final deposit stage is assessed as likely based on common fake job scam patterns, but was not directly observed in the available evidence.

4. Context of the Incident

The victim was contacted by an individual claiming association with **HIGHLIGHT**. The person used the name **AIDEN CHONG** and stated that the victim profile had been recommended by **OLIVEIRA NOGUEIRA**.

Referenced LinkedIn profile:

```
linkedin.com/in/danielleoliveira-dev
```

The proposed activity involved NFTs. The stated objective was to improve the visibility, ranking or sales volume of developers' NFTs.

Domains mentioned or analyzed:

```
https://highlight.xyz/
https://www.highlight.pro/
https://highlight-global.xyz/
```

Official NFT/Web3 domain observed:

```
https://highlight.xyz/
```

Suspicious work platform domain:

```
https://highlight-global.xyz/
```

Phone numbers associated with the exchange:

```
+1 812-979-XXXX
+33 6 89 91 XX XX
```

Referral code provided (redacted for public release):

```
HB6XX
```

5. Timeline

5.1 Graphical Timeline

```
LinkedIn context
|
v
```

```

RCS approach from +1 812-979-XXXX
|
v
Job opportunity introduced
|
v
NFT task explanation
|
v
highlight-global.xyz shared
|
v
Referral code HB6XX shared
|
v
Salary and commission explained
|
v
Withdraw password mentioned
|
v
Victim requests official proof
|
v
Actor provides evasive explanation
|
v
OSINT investigation initiated

```

5.2 Event Timeline

Time Observed	Event
12:22	Initial RCS contact from +1 812-979-XXXX. The actor references a previous LinkedIn cybersecurity analyst application and introduces another remote opportunity.
13:46	The victim continues the exchange and agrees to receive more information.
13:48	The actor describes a role related to improving NFTs.
13:59	The actor sends https://highlight-global.xyz/ and a referral code redacted as HB6XX.
14:00	The actor asks the victim to send back their own referral code after registration.
16:54	The actor explains the concept as improving NFT ranking and visibility to generate more sales.
16:56	The actor describes a semi-automated website where the user clicks Improve NFTs then Submit .
17:20	The victim requests contact from an official highlight.xyz email and a formal contract before registration.
17:30	The actor claims participants are agents, not official Highlight employees.
17:34	The victim questions the use of highlight-global.xyz , which differs from highlight.xyz .
17:50	The actor claims that highlight.xyz is the frontend and highlight-global.xyz is the backend.
18:40	The victim requests public official proof on highlight.xyz .
18:47	The actor reformulates the claim without providing verifiable proof.

6. Comparison: highlight.xyz vs highlight-global.xyz

Criterion	highlight.xyz	highlight-global.xyz
Assessment	Official NFT/Web3 platform observed	Suspicious domain
Legal entity	Sea Ranch Labs, Inc. d/b/a Highlight	No verifiable entity observed
Registration date	2018-12-08	2026-06-15
Registrar	NameCheap, Inc.	Dynadot Inc
DNS infrastructure	AWS Route53	Cloudflare
HTTP stack	AWS CloudFront / Next.js	Cloudflare / SPA
Mail exchange	Google Workspace MX configured	No MX observed
TXT verification	Google, Stripe, Atlassian, SPF, DKIM	No equivalent validation observed
Official contact	gm@highlight.xyz , support@highlight.xyz	No official contact observed

Criterion	highlight.xyz	highlight-global.xyz
Documentation	support.highlight.xyz	None observed
Public social links	x.com/Highlight_xyz, Farcaster	None observed
Declared usage	NFT creation, minting and collection	Work platform, salary, commission, withdrawal
Confidence assessment	Legitimate official platform	High confidence of impersonation

The official [highlight.xyz](#) platform describes Highlight as a platform for creating, minting and collecting digital art and NFTs.

The suspicious [highlight-global.xyz](#) domain implements a workflow involving tasks, salaries, commissions, referrals, wallets and withdrawals. This is not consistent with the public operation of the official Highlight platform.

7. DNS / WHOIS / TLS / HTTP Analysis

7.1 RDAP / WHOIS Observations

Suspicious domain:

```
Domain: highlight-global.xyz
Registrar: Dynadot Inc
Creation date: 2026-06-15T19:21:18Z
Expiration date: 2027-06-15T23:59:59Z
Nameservers:
- autumn.ns.cloudflare.com
- sean.ns.cloudflare.com
```

Official domain:

```
Domain: highlight.xyz
Registrar: NameCheap, Inc.
Creation date: 2018-12-08T18:32:09Z
Expiration date: 2032-12-08T23:59:59Z
Nameservers:
- ns-71.awsdns-08.com
- ns-687.awsdns-21.net
- ns-1232.awsdns-26.org
- ns-1945.awsdns-51.co.uk
```

Suspicious API domain:

```
Domain: apihighlight.xyz
Registrar: Dynadot Inc
Creation date: 2026-04-19T06:14:23Z
Nameservers:
- autumn.ns.cloudflare.com
- sean.ns.cloudflare.com
```

Suspicious chat-related domain:

```
Domain: dot01mf.cfd
Registrar: Dynadot Inc
Creation date: 2026-03-27T06:56:53Z
Nameservers:
- ns1.dyna-ns.net
- ns2.dyna-ns.net
```

7.2 DNS Observations

[highlight-global.xyz](#):

```
highlight-global.xyz A 104.21.17.56
highlight-global.xyz A 172.67.222.86
highlight-global.xyz NS sean.ns.cloudflare.com
highlight-global.xyz NS autumn.ns.cloudflare.com
```

[highlight.xyz](#):

```
highlight.xyz A 13.227.231.57
highlight.xyz A 13.227.231.88
highlight.xyz A 13.227.231.123
highlight.xyz A 13.227.231.128
```

highlight.xyz MX records:

```
aspmx.l.google.com
alt1.aspmx.l.google.com
alt2.aspmx.l.google.com
alt3.aspmx.l.google.com
alt4.aspmx.l.google.com
```

deeplink.apihighlight.xyz:

```
deeplink.apihighlight.xyz A 188.114.96.2
deeplink.apihighlight.xyz A 188.114.97.2
```

cf.dot01mf.cfd:

```
cf.dot01mf.cfd CNAME chat.imkefu.uk
```

7.3 TLS Fingerprints

Host	Subject	Issuer	Serial	Validity	SAN	SHA
highlight-global.xyz	CN=highlight-global.xyz	CN=WE1, O=Google Trust Services, C=US	008FF89480FD7911BA13F8EE1A7E40F9BF	2026-06-15 to 2026-09-13	highlight-global.xyz, *.highlight-global.xyz	4c:
highlight.xyz	CN=highlight.xyz	CN=Amazon RSA 2048 M01, O=Amazon, C=US	01D905B7F2AB2F322D8EE707750C3EFE	2026-02-24 to 2026-09-09	highlight.xyz, *.highlight.xyz	c6:
deeplink.apihighlight.xyz	CN=apihighlight.xyz	CN=YE1, O=Let's Encrypt, C=US	0584792FD84C801DD6236173510FCCD5587C	2026-06-17 to 2026-09-15	*.apihighlight.xyz, apihighlight.xyz	b2:
cf.dot01mf.cfd	CN=cf.dot01mf.cfd	CN=Cloudflare TLS Issuing ECC CA 4, O=SSL Corporation, C=US	75868B2CCAEF6E6E441A413E7D14001F	2026-06-10 to 2026-09-08	cf.dot01mf.cfd	15:

7.4 HTTP Observations

highlight-global.xyz response headers:

```
HTTP/1.1 200 OK
Server: cloudflare
Content-Type: text/html
Strict-Transport-Security: max-age=31536000
Set-Cookie: server_session_178b516b=...
```

The page title is:

```
<title>Highlight</title>
```

The HTML contains:

```
<meta name="robots" content="noindex, nofollow">
```

The `noindex, nofollow` directive indicates the site attempts to avoid search engine indexing, which is frequently observed on temporary or low-reputation infrastructure.

The `www.highlight-global.xyz` host did not resolve at the time of analysis:

```
Could not resolve host: www.highlight-global.xyz
```

7.5 API Error Disclosure

The suspicious API endpoint returned JSON and leaked a PHP warning:

```
{"valid":false,"error":"error.404","data":{"returnMsg":["error.404"]}}
```

```
Warning: Undefined variable $secondFilename in /www/wwwroot/highlight/api/runtime/config/middleware.php on line 91
```

This discloses a PHP backend path and differs from the observed official Highlight stack, which uses Next.js and CloudFront.

8. Frontend Code Analysis

The suspicious frontend loads a JavaScript application:

```
/assets/index.39bb6ab0.js
```

Observed routes:

```
/login  
/register  
/referral  
/salary  
/withdraw  
/withdraw/record
```

Observed JavaScript chunks:

```
login.b8a16bed.js  
register.24fc3ddc.js  
referral.b17cd46e.js  
salary.8847252f.js  
record.be933b87.js
```

Observed suspicious strings:

```
withdraw  
salary  
referral  
invite  
wallet  
commission  
nft  
login  
register  
password  
improve  
submit  
USDC  
security_password
```

The `security_password` field is particularly relevant because it maps to the "withdraw password" described by the actor during the conversation.

The frontend also references:


```
https://api.telegram.org/bot
https://deeplink.apihighlight.xyz/society/
```

8.1 SHA256 Hashes

File	SHA256
index.39bb6ab0.js	ea42fceb0d7ee905dceb2d5ad0381a4026cd86174733028f43504e5414d7ccee
login.b8a16bed.js	1a17fef77d49c0f10d3eb9521f183f5f673b1683bf476e7d2cb84c1db0396539
register.24fc3ddc.js	d78b04d4c20419c0dcae65d56de2a7dc5c2697de7cece7a654ab21e7fa2da2ff
referral.b17cd46e.js	5c8394162032c71d1c966c51f886f1ec178f922918e325dd46f74a0ad9b48764
salary.8847252f.js	eed4836bacb4b030cc05cfbd65af8a69888a5306f0d190f36410b8c0aa9177cb

9. Behavioral Analysis

9.1 Pretext

The actor uses a credible professional pretext by referencing a previous LinkedIn cybersecurity analyst application.

This creates contextual legitimacy and increases the chance that the victim continues the conversation.

9.2 Brand Impersonation

The actor uses the Highlight brand and attempts to associate the suspicious platform with **highlight.xyz**.

Observed terms:

```
Highlight
highlight.xyz
highlight-global.xyz
Highlight project
```

This creates ambiguity between the legitimate platform and the suspicious work portal.

9.3 Lack of Official Proof

When asked to provide official confirmation, the actor did not provide:

- An email from **@highlight.xyz**.
- A public page on **highlight.xyz**.
- A formal contract.
- A public announcement.
- A verifiable authorization statement.

The actor only stated that **highlight.xyz** was the frontend and **highlight-global.xyz** was the backend. This claim is not supported by the technical evidence.

9.4 Reward Promise

The actor promised:

```
$80-$200 a day
1-2 hours
paid every day
```

This is consistent with common fake job scams and task scams.

9.5 Task Mechanics

The proposed activity consists of improving NFTs by increasing their ranking, visibility or sales volume.

Observed actor statements:

```
improve their NFT ranking and visibility
improve real sale volumes of low sales NFTs
When you click on Improve NFTs, the system will automatically queue and assign the NFTs to you
```

This behavior resembles artificial activity generation. The official Highlight terms prohibit manipulative activity such as wash trading, pump-and-dump behavior and artificial market activity.

9.6 Referral Mechanism

The actor provided a referral code, redacted for public release:

```
HB6XX
```

Referral mechanisms are commonly used in fake job campaigns to track victims and create a sense of onboarding legitimacy.

9.7 Withdrawal Password

The actor emphasized the importance of remembering a withdrawal password:

```
especially the withdraw password, because it is used to withdraw your salary
```

This is a high-risk indicator. Legitimate employment compensation is generally handled through contracts, payroll, bank transfer, or a verified payment provider, not through an anonymous portal requiring a separate withdrawal password.

10. Indicators of Compromise

10.1 Domains

```
highlight-global.xyz  
apihighlight.xyz  
deeplink.apihighlight.xyz  
dot01mf.cfd  
cf.dot01mf.cfd  
chat.imkefu.uk
```

10.2 URLs

```
https://highlight-global.xyz/  
https://highlight-global.xyz/assets/index.39bb6ab0.js  
https://highlight-global.xyz/assets/login.b8a16bed.js  
https://highlight-global.xyz/assets/register.24fc3ddc.js  
https://highlight-global.xyz/assets/referral.b17cd46e.js  
https://highlight-global.xyz/assets/salary.8847252f.js  
https://deeplink.apihighlight.xyz/society/  
https://cf.dot01mf.cfd/chat/widget.js
```

10.3 Hashes

```
ea42fceb0d7ee905dceb2d5ad0381a4026cd86174733028f43504e5414d7ccee  
1a17fef77d49c0f10d3eb9521f183f5f673b1683bf476e7d2cb84c1db0396539  
d78b04d4c20419c0dcae65d56de2a7dc5c2697de7cece7a654ab21e7fa2da2ff  
5c8394162032c71d1c966c51f886f1ec178f922918e325dd46f74a0ad9b48764  
eed4836bacb4b030cc05cfbd65af8a69888a5306f0d190f36410b8c0aa9177cb
```

10.4 Communication Indicators

```
+1 812-979-XXXX  
+33 6 89 91 XX XX
```

10.5 Artefacts

```
AIDEN CHONG  
OLIVEIRA NOGUEIRA  
HB6XX  
linkedin.com/in/danielleoliveira-dev
```

11. Observables

11.1 Shared Infrastructure

The following IP addresses are associated with shared infrastructure providers and should not be blocked broadly without additional context:

```
104.21.17.56
172.67.222.86
188.114.96.2
188.114.97.2
104.26.10.238
104.26.11.238
172.67.71.250
13.227.231.57
13.227.231.88
13.227.231.123
13.227.231.128
```

11.2 Technical Observables

```
Cloudflare
AWS CloudFront
AWS Route53
Next.js
PHP backend disclosure
Telegram Bot API reference
Google Trust Services certificate
Let's Encrypt certificate
Cloudflare TLS certificate
```

11.3 Frontend Observables

```
security_password
withdraw_record
table_withdrawal_usdc
register_account
table_referral_code
table_salary_list
table_commission
Improve
Submit
USDC
```

12. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Mapping is based on available observations. Some techniques are assessed as likely but not fully confirmed.

Technique	Name	Assessment	Observation
T1583.001	Acquire Infrastructure: Domains	Confirmed	Recent registration of highlight-global.xyz , apihighlight.xyz , and dot01mf.cfd .
T1585	Establish Accounts	Likely	Use of apparent recruiter identities and social profiles to approach the victim.
T1566	Phishing	Confirmed	Direct messaging and redirection to a suspicious portal.
T1036	Masquerading	Confirmed	highlight-global.xyz imitates the Highlight brand and claims association with highlight.xyz .
T1204	User Execution	Confirmed	Victim is instructed to register, interact with the portal, and perform tasks.

Removed from final mapping: [T1110](#). No brute-force activity was observed. Credential harvesting remains a risk based on login, registration and withdrawal password functionality, but it is not mapped to brute force.

13. Recommendations

13.1 For the Victim

Do not create an account on:

```
highlight-global.xyz
```

Do not provide:

Password
Withdrawal password
Personal email
Phone number
Identity documents
Crypto wallet seed phrase
Banking information

Do not perform any crypto deposit, even if presented as:

Unlocking withdrawal
Validating an account
Activating salary
Paying gas fees
Completing a task

Block the observed numbers:

+1 812-979-XXXX
+33 6 89 91 XX XX

Preserve evidence:

Screenshots
URLs
Phone numbers
Referral code
Dates and times
Full messages
HTTP headers
RDAP / DNS results
JavaScript files and hashes
TLS fingerprints

13.2 Reporting

Report suspicious domains to Dynadot:

abuse@dynadot.com

Report abusive Cloudflare use:

<https://abuse.cloudflare.com/>

Notify official Highlight contacts:

support@highlight.xyz
gm@highlight.xyz

Report phishing:

https://safebrowsing.google.com/safebrowsing/report_phish/
<https://phishing-initiative.eu/>
<https://www.cybermalveillance.gouv.fr/>
<https://www.signal-spam.fr/>

13.3 SOC / Blue Team Recommendations

Monitor domains:

```
highlight-global.xyz
apihighlight.xyz
dot01mf.cfd
cf.dot01mf.cfd
chat.imkefu.uk
```

Search proxy, DNS, EDR or SIEM logs for:

```
security_password
withdraw_record
table_withdrawal_usdc
HB6XX
highlight-global
apihighlight
dot01mf
```

Create behavioral detections for fake crypto job portals combining:

```
register
salary
withdraw
commission
referral
USDC
security_password
```

Avoid broad blocking of Cloudflare or AWS CloudFront IPs. Prefer domain, URL and certificate-based detections where possible.

14. Conclusion

The investigation identifies a structured fake recruitment campaign leveraging the Highlight brand and targeting job seekers in a Web3/NFT context.

There is **high confidence** that `highlight-global.xyz` is not operated by `Sea Ranch Labs, Inc. d/b/a Highlight` and is not part of the official `highlight.xyz` infrastructure.

Key supporting findings include:

- `highlight-global.xyz` was registered on `2026-06-15`, while `highlight.xyz` has existed since `2018-12-08`.
- The suspicious infrastructure uses Dynadot and Cloudflare, while the official platform uses NameCheap, AWS Route53, CloudFront and Next.js.
- The suspicious portal implements salary, referral, wallet, commission and withdrawal functionality.
- The actor failed to provide official proof from `highlight.xyz` or an `@highlight.xyz` email address.
- The proposed task appears to involve artificial manipulation of NFT visibility or sales volume, inconsistent with the official Highlight terms of service.

Final verdict:

`highlight-global.xyz` should be treated as illegitimate and potentially fraudulent unless an official confirmation is published directly by `highlight.xyz` or provided from a verified `@highlight.xyz` address.

15. Annexes

Annex A - User-Provided Evidence

- WhatsApp screenshots.
- RCS screenshots.
- Conversation excerpts.
- Referral code redacted as `HB6XX`.

Annex B - Reputation Screenshots

- VirusTotal screenshot for `highlight-global.xyz`.
- Anti-Abuse Project screenshot.

Annex C - WHOIS / RDAP

- RDAP output for `highlight-global.xyz`.
- RDAP output for `highlight.xyz`.
- RDAP output for `apihighlight.xyz`.
- RDAP output for `dot01mf.cfd`.

Annex D - DNS

- A records.
- NS records.
- MX records.
- CNAME records.

Annex E - HTTP Headers

- `highlight-global.xyz` headers.
- `highlight.xyz` headers.
- `deeplink.apihighlight.xyz` headers.
- `cf.dot01mf.cfd` headers.

Annex F - JavaScript Artefacts

- `index.39bb6ab0.js`.
- `login.b8a16bed.js`.
- `register.24fc3ddc.js`.
- `referral.b17cd46e.js`.
- `salary.8847252f.js`.

Annex G - TLS

- Certificate subjects.
- Issuers.
- Serial numbers.
- Validity windows.
- SHA256 fingerprints.
- SAN values.